

» ASPARAGALES

**GRASS TREE**

Xanthorrhoea australis
F: Asphodelaceae

Perhaps living for up to 450 years, this bushfire-resistant Australian plant develops a sturdy trunk and a spherical crown of narrow leaves.

**COMMON ASPHODEL**

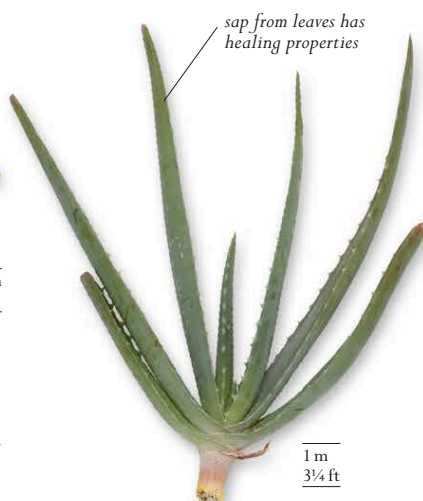
Asphodelus aestivus
F: Asphodelaceae

This common narrow-leaved Mediterranean plant produces many pinkish white flowers on a tall stem.

**NEW ZEALAND FLAX**

Phormium tenax
F: Asphodelaceae

This common New Zealand species grows large leaves at ground level and a tall flower stalk bearing tubular reddish flowers.

**MEDICINAL ALOE**

Aloe vera
F: Asphodelaceae

This spiny succulent adapted to dry areas has been cultivated since ancient times for its reputed medicinal properties.

**ORANGE DAY LILY**

Hemerocallis fulva
F: Asphodelaceae

Each flower of this ornamental species lasts just one day. Native to Asia, it can be an invasive weed in N. America.

orange-red
flower spike
fades to yellow
near base

**RED HOT POKER**

Kniphofia uvaria
F: Asphodelaceae

Native to the S.W. tip of Africa, this multi-flowered lily with long, narrow leaves is now a popular ornamental specimen.

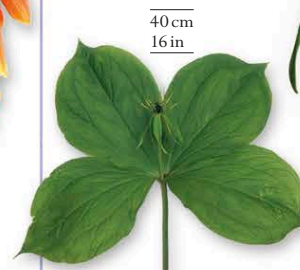
LILIALES

Many plants once considered part of the lily family, including onions and hyacinths, have been moved into the order Asparagales (see pp.132–39). The ten families in the Liliales include the true lilies and tulips, the sarsaparilla and colchicum families, and the colourful alstroemeria family from the New World. Beware that several lily species are highly toxic to cats.

**WILD TULIP**

Tulipa sylvestris
F: Liliaceae

Still widespread as a native plant in southern Europe, this yellow-flowered relative of the cultivated garden tulip grows wild in meadows, open woodland, and rocky places.

**HERB PARIS**

Paris quadrifolia
F: Liliaceae

Found in ancient woodland in temperate Eurasia, this four-leaved plant has a single green flower that develops into a black inedible fruit.

**SNAKESHEAD FRITILLARY**

Fritillaria meleagris
F: Liliaceae

This bulb-forming European species has distinctive chequered flowers. It grows wild in damp meadows but is more common in cultivation.

DIOSCOREALES

This order contains just three families. It is dominated by the yams, a family of mainly tropical climbing plants. Several species of yam have been cultivated since ancient times for their edible tubers. The small bog asphodel family is mainly north temperate.

**YAM**

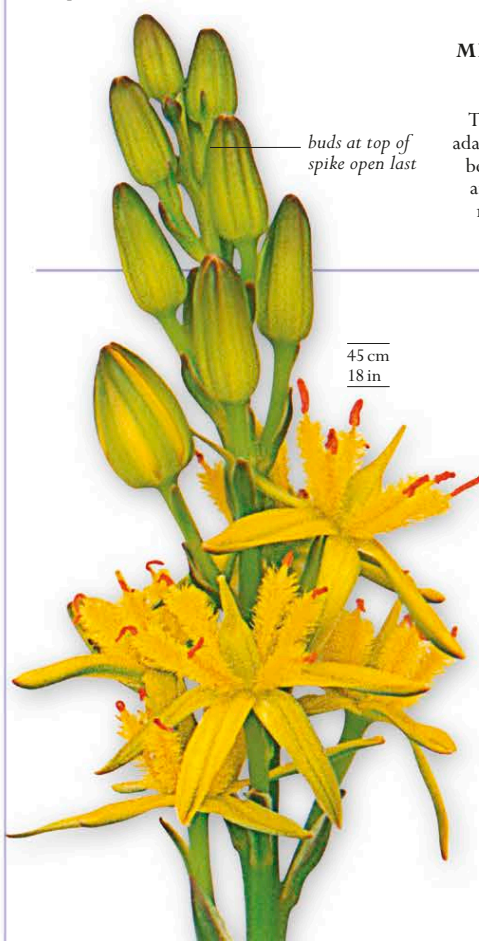
Dioscorea sp.
F: Dioscoreaceae

Widely cultivated in the tropics, yams grow large, starch-rich tubers. Plants have stems that trail or climb and heart-shaped leaves.

BOG ASPHODEL

Narthecium ossifragum
F: Nartheciaceae

This European plant lives in nutrient-poor upland habitats. After fertilization, its seed capsules develop a fiery orange colour.

**BLACK BRYONY**

Tamus communis
F: Dioscoreaceae

This poisonous European climbing plant of the yam family is named for its black underground tuber. Its globular fruits turn bright red when ripe.

